

The present Haryana government understood quite early the need to provide technical education not only to feed the booming industry but to provide gainful employment to the youth.

The result is that now every year, over a lakh of youths are getting employment-oriented technical education. New technical universities, a host of engineering institutes of world standard, management and other professional institutes now dot all the districts of Haryana.

Amanbir Brar/ Aparna Pawar

If one wants to meet change in person, one must visit Haryana. From a monotonous tract of parched land and poor cousin of a disdainful big brother in the 1960s, the state is now a statement in diversity and prosperity. And the metamorphosis is nowhere as striking as in economic domain. From the depressing grey, the land mass across the state stands draped in green; the skyline is dotted with totems of modern industries and roads one feels like rolling up and take home! From also-ran, the state has

leapfrogged into the top league; it is now hub of information technology, and automobile and petroleum industries, to say the least.

The intensity of the government's single-mindedness can be gauged from the fact that in a span of just five years, starting from 2004-05, the number of technical institutions in the state has grown up by a staggering 350 per cent; it shot from 145 to 489 in this period. The number of boys and girls enrolling every year registered a fourfold increase. From a mere 24,124 in 2004-05,

the number has touched the one lakh mark - 1,01,865 to be precise. And dude, it takes quite a few bucks, put in the new generation lingo! From a humble Rs 29 crore in 2004-05, a sum of Rs 158 crore has been set aside in the current financial year to keep the forward march on.

The tectonic shift in the ground situation was not a solo drumbeat. The government was there, moving in swiftly to turn it into a symphony by dotting the state with excellent centres of technical education. As industrial towns

